

ORDER OF WORSHIP
ETERNAL HOPE UCC
December 12, 2021
THIRD SUNDAY OF ADVENT
THE CANDLE OF JOY

WELCOME TO ETERNAL HOPE UCC

Call to Worship:

O: the day foretold is coming.

A: When our bitter mouths will drink new wine, God's cup raised high at the kingdom's table

O: The one foretold is coming—

A: Whose bread will be broken in deepest gloom: a last supper shared on a silent night!

O: The day is at hand!

A: World, feast!

O: The savior draws near!

A: Praise the Lord!

Opening Song: Joy to the World, Unspeakable Joy

Welcome and Announcements :

Check in:

Advent opportunities

Prayer requests.

Update on the move

Opening Prayer: O God of the Coming One, we have come to draw water from your well. We trust, we will not be afraid, for you have promised that the taste of this water will not be bitter, like the tears of our eyes, but sweet, like the honey of flowers. May we put our hopes, peace, and joy in You.AMEN

Lighting of 3rd Advent candle:

Reader 1: Joy is the space between your breath and your laughter.

Reader 2: Joy is a hand wrapped around yours; your heart beating in sync with someone else's heart.

Reader 1: Joy is that first day of a new season, and the hope it brings

Reader 2: Joy is dancing in the kitchen and singing in the car

Reader 1: Joy is the first cry of a newborn

Reader 2: Joy is contagious, joy is a song.

Reader 1: Joy is the daughter of gratitude

Reader 2: Joy is the heart of praise

Reader 1: Today we light the candle of joy for all we stated above and more importantly as a sign of gratitude for a God who makes water in the desert, heals the sick, offers sight to the blind and who knows us by name.

Reader 2: May we realize our joy. AMEN

**Praise and Worship: My Soul Magnifies the Lord
There Was Jesus**

Scripture: Luke 3:7-18

**Sermon:
Rev. Rachel Shawler**

Offertory: The giving of our tithes and gifts.

BLESSING OF THE GIFTS: Today, Lord we offer you our sacrifice of time, energy, and love, knowing full well they are mere tokens of the awesome faith you inspire within us. Accept these gifts, that they may continue the good work in Christ in our church, in our community, and in the world. In Jesus' name.

PRAYERS OF THE PEOPLE: Rev. Booth

COMMUNION: Rev. Rachel Shawler
Joy to the World.

ADVENT ACTIVITY: Fellowship

THANK YOU FOR WORSHIPPING WITH US. SEE YOU NEXT WEEK.

11/28/12
Eternity
Hope UCC

ADVENT: faith & fellowship

hope

"We are all mothers to God, for God is always waiting to be born."

-meister Eckhart

Storytelling

tell your table a short story
about a time you've felt
hope during the holidays,
or during the last few weeks/
months

Since advent is about waiting
in the dark, set the scene for us,
tell us how you felt.

I remember, your story doesn't have
to be about anything huge. It
could be about a small moment,
like something a loved one did, or
it could be about something you
heard from someone else.

If you can't think of anything
(do try first!), tell us about a
favorite or memorable gift you've
received.

Discussion

Luke 21:25-34

to close →

listen for what stands out to you.
do you imagine anything you hear?

can you see places where God's
kingdom is already here? like
the signs of the fig tree?

what is your response to the passage?
to the idea of the second coming
of Christ, or God's future plan for us?

imagine what do you think Christ's
second coming would be like?

what would it not be like?

what would pass away?

what would stay true?

what if Christ who comes again is
not a man, but a woman? Not straight
but gay or gender fluid? Is not ab-
bodied? Is not as we typically
imagine him? →

ADAMANT: WITH FOLLOWING

good

How does Imagining Christ's second coming, or the breaking-in of the Kingdom of God, make you feel about the NOW?

Does it call you to anything?

unbelieving?

11/28/51
Haber
Eaton